

☐ RARE OR UNUSUAL RECORD☐ NEW STATE RECORD☒ ACCEPTED☐ REJECTEDSpecies: Purple Finch

(Vernacular Name)

Carpodacus purpureus

(Scientific Name-use binomial)

Date(s): 1/22/77Time Bird Seen: 9:15 amto 9:30 amLocality: Boany ReservoirNearest Town: Idalia or HaleCounty: Yuma

Other observers who independently identified this bird:

NAME

ADDRESS

TELEPHONE

Jurld Sundine 4305 E. Florida Ave Denver 80222 756-1116Pete Moulton (1/29/77) 1328 S. Coffman #3 Longmont 80501 772-0282Optical Equipment: 7X35 binoculars

If photographed, type of equipment used: _____

Light Conditions: _____

Distance from bird (how measured): 30' - 50' (estimated)Number of Birds Seen: 2Sex: ♀ or imm? Plumage: _____

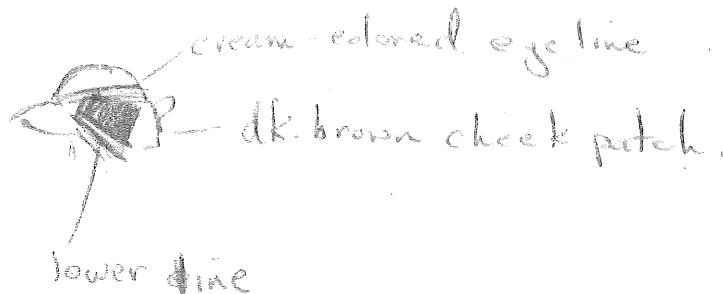
Describe the bird's overall behavior and demeanor:

I first saw the birds in an association with slate-colored and Oregon Juncos. The 1st bird flew into a coniferous tree and began to call. After about 10 minutes it flew from the shelterbelt. As it left, I saw another one.

Describe in great detail the bird's size, overall shape, plumage and color-pattern.

Include details on shape of bill, wings and tail. Give particular emphasis to the marks you used to identify the bird. Reference to its resemblance in field guide descriptions is not enough. Describe what you actually saw in the field:

Both birds resembled miniature grosbeaks. They were Junco sized with thick conical bills, heavily streaked breasts, and a distinct darkish brown cheek patch, separated by a cream-colored eyeline and another cream-colored line that extended from the area of the lores down and towards the body.



The streaking on the breast did not continue to the area of the undertail. This area (OVER) from between the legs to the tail, was clear and whitish.

Describe the bird's song or call, if heard, including method of delivery, i.e., from perch, in flight, etc:

The call sounded like churr-leep, churr-leep

Describe the habitat in which you observed this bird:

Shelterbelt of mixed coniferous & deciduous trees.

How were similarly appearing species eliminated? Both the Cassin's Finch and the House Finch, strongly resemble the Purple Finch, in ♀ plumage.

I eliminated the Cassin's Finch because it seems to be more finely streaked and lacks the well-defined cheek-patch.

The House Finch is not a cleanly marked bird. ♀'s lack the definite cheek-patch.

(see extra sheet)

Prior experience with this and similarly appearing species:

I've seen Purple Finches in Wisconsin and E. Kansas

I've seen many House Finches and Cassin's Finches in Colorado.

Books, illustrations and advice consulted and how did these influence this documentation?

This report was written from notes made during X after observation; from memory

PRINT NAME: Mike Moulton SIGNATURE: Mike Moulton DATE: 2/9/77
Street Address: 1328 S. Coffman #3 Town and State: Longmont, Colo ZIP: 80501

Return to: JACK REDDALL - 4450 South Alton Street, Englewood, Colorado 80110

Purple Finch form.

One must exercise extreme caution when identifying a Purple Finch in Colorado. The House Finch and Cassin's Finch are both well represented here, and both are similar to the Purple Finch.

In glancing at my records for Bonny Res. I have records for House Finch for only 1 date. 8/27/76. There is one Cassin's Finch report from 1/1/73. It is my feeling that both House Finches and Cassin's Finches are "uncommon" at best, at Bonny.

I feel that the severe weather conditions in the east coupled with the geographical location of Bonny, heavily influenced my identification.

Mike Moulton

Species: PURPLE FINCH (Vernacular Name) Carpodacus purpureus (Scientific Name-use binomial)

Date(s): JAN 22, 1977 Time Bird Seen: 0915 to 0930
Locality: NORTH ROAD BERRY DAM / 2ND MAJOR SHELTER BELT FROM FOSTER GROVE / .4 MI. EAST OF FOSTER GROVE
Nearest Town: IDAHO COLO. County: YUMA

Other observers who independently identified this bird:

NAME	ADDRESS	TELEPHONE
<u>MIKE MOUNTON</u>	<u>1328 S. COFFMAN #3 LONGMONT</u>	<u>1-772-0283</u>
<u>PETE MOUNTON</u>	<u>" " " "</u>	<u>" " " "</u>
<u>LINDA CARPENTER</u>	<u>BOX 22 IDAHO COLO.</u>	<u>1-354-7364</u>

Optical Equipment: PENNCREST 7-50 BINOCULARS
If photographed, type of equipment used: _____
Light Conditions: LIGHT CLOUDS - GOOD LIGHT BUT NOT FULL SUN
Distance from bird (how measured): 15-25 METERS ESTIMATED

Number of Birds Seen: 3-(1 WELL) Sex: FEMALE Plumage: _____

Describe the bird's overall behavior and demeanor: THE WHOLE TIME THE BIRD WAS SEEN BY ME, SHE MOVED BACK AND FORTH ALONG THE GROUNDS. THE BIRD STAYED AMONG THE ONE-SEED JUNIPERS (JUNIPERUS MONOSPERMA) THAT ARE PREVALENT. TWO OTHER BIRDS, THAT WERE NOT SEEN AS WELL AS THE FIRST BUT HAD THE SAME FIELD MARKS AS THE FIRST, FLEW IN WITH THE SEEN BIRD, THEY ALL FLEW OUT TOGETHER INTO A RUSSIAN OLIVE (ELEAGNUS ANGUSTIFOLIA). THERE WAS NOT ENOUGH TIME TO OBSERVE THEM WELL BEFORE THEY FLEW. THE ONE BIRD WAS OBSERVED FOR 15 MINUTES.

Describe in great detail the bird's size, overall shape, plumage and color-pattern. Include details on shape of bill, wings and tail. Give particular emphasis to the marks you used to identify the bird. Reference to its resemblance in field guide descriptions is not enough. Describe what you actually saw in the field:

THE BIRD THAT WAS OBSERVED WAS SPARROW SIZE. (EXCLUDE HARRIS' SPARROW). THE BIRD HAD MODERATELY TO HEAVILY STREAKED SIDES AND BREAST WITH THE STREAKING ENDING 1/2 TO 2/3 DOWN THE BREAST. TOP OF THE BIRD WAS DARKER THAN WAS THE BOTTOM HALF. UNDERTAIL COVERTS WERE CLEAR. TAIL WAS DEEPLY NOTCHED. THE IDENTIFYING FEATURE USED WAS THE LARGE CHEEK PATCH. HEAD PATTERN FROM TOP TO BOTTOM WAS BROWN, WHITE, BROWN, WHITE, BROWN. THAT IS BROWN BROWN, WHITE STRIPE BEHIND THE EYE, BROWN CHEEK PATCH, WHITE STRIPE UNDER CHEEK PATCH AND BROWN THROAT.



CONICAL BEAK.

Describe the bird's song or call, if heard, including method of delivery, i.e., from perch, in flight, etc: THE CALL, IF YOU WILL, WAS HEARD WHILE THE BIRD WAS IN FLIGHT. THE CALL WAS "CHURLEEP-CHURLEEP."

Describe the habitat in which you observed this bird: MIXED CONIFEROUS AND DECIDUOUS SHELTER BELT. SANDHILL PLUM, RUSSIAN OLIVE, AND MULBERRIES DOMINATE THE ~~MAKE UP~~ DECIDUOUS MATERIAL WHILE ONE-SEED JUNIPERS AND ROCKY MOUNTAIN JUNIPERS ~~MAKE UP~~ THE CONIFEROUS MATERIAL. A SHORTGRASS UNDERSTORY WAS PRESENT. THE BIRD STAYED ALONG THE GROUND MOST OF THE TIME UNTIL IT TOOK OFF AS IT, AND TWO OTHER BIRDS WERE BEING APPROACHED.

How were similarly appearing species eliminated?

SIMILAR SPECIES CONCEIVABLY COULD BE THE ♀ CASSINS FINCH AND THE ♀ HOUSE FINCH. THE CLINCHING FIELD MARKS FOR ME WAS THE DISTINCT HEAD PATTERN (CONTRAST) AND THE CLEAR UNDERTAIL COVERTS. THE DEEPLY NOTCHED TAIL ELIMINATES THE HOUSE FINCH AND THE CLEAR UNDERTAIL COVERTS ELIMINATES THE CASSINS FINCH.

Prior experience with this and similarly appearing species: NO OTHER (EXTENSIVE) EXPERIENCE WITH CASSINS OR PURPLE FINCH. SUBMITTER IS FAMILIAR WITH HOUSE FINCH.

Books, illustrations and advice consulted and how did these influence this documentation? BIRDS OF NORTH AMERICA WAS CONSULTED TO FIND RANGE OF BIRD. DID NOT INFLUENCE DOCUMENTATION AT ALL.

This report was written from notes made during X after observation; from memory

PRINT NAME: JUDD SUNDINE SIGNATURE: Judd E Sundine DATE: 2/8/77
Street Address: 4305 E. FLORIDA Town and State: DENVER, Colo. ZIP: 80222

Return to: JACK REDDALL - 1450 South Alton Street, Englewood, Colorado 80110

Species: PURPLE FINCH (Vernacular Name) CARPODACUS PURPUREUS (Scientific Name-use binomial)

Date(s): 29 JANUARY, 1977 Time Bird Seen: 2:30 PM to 2:35 PM

Locality: BOONNY RESERVOIR - FOSTER GROVE CAMPGROUND

Nearest Town: IDALIA County: YUMA

Other observers who independently identified this bird:

NAME

ADDRESS

TELEPHONE

Optical Equipment: 7X35 BINOCULARS

If photographed, type of equipment used: _____

Light Conditions: EXCELLENT

Distance from bird (how measured): CA 30 FT. ESTIMATED

Number of Birds Seen: 1 Sex: ♀ (PROB) Plumage: ♀ OR IMMATURE

Describe the bird's overall behavior and demeanor:

BIRD WAS SEEN WITH JUNCOS IN SHELTERBELT. IT WAS SOMEWHAT LESS ACTIVE THAN THE JUNCOS, WITH MORE ARBOREAL TENDENCIES. IT WAS OBSERVED AS IT WORKED THROUGH A BARE RUSSIAN OLIVE, CREEPING AMONG THE LIMBS ALMOST LIKE A VIREO, BUT MORE ACTIVELY. IT WAS NOT OBSERVED EATING THE BERRIES. IT RARELY FLITTED BUT MADE DELIBERATE EVOLUTIONS SO THAT NEARLY ALL OF IT WAS VISIBLE AT SOME TIME DURING THE OBSERVATION.

Describe in great detail the bird's size, overall shape, plumage and color-pattern.

Include details on shape of bill, wings and tail. Give particular emphasis to the marks you used to identify the bird. Reference to its resemblance in field guide descriptions is not enough. Describe what you actually saw in the field:

SIZE AND SHAPE X LIKE A LARGE HOUSE FINCH, THOUGH NOT SO LARGE AS CASSIN'S FINCH.

CROWN, NAPE, BACK, WINGS, RUMP, UPPERSIDE OF TAIL, SIDE OF THROAT, CHEEK BROWN. SIDE OF THROAT AND CHEEK RICH BROWN. UPPERPARTS A DARKER GRAY-BROWN. FINE DARK STREAKINGS ON CROWN, COARSE DARK GRAY-BROWN STREAKS ON BACK. RUMP WITHOUT OBVIOUS STREAKS. WINGS AND TAIL DARKER THAN BACK AND RUMP. WINGS WITHOUT BARS. TAIL VERY DEEPLY NOTCHED AND RATHER SHORT AND NARROW.

UNDERPARTS, SUPERCILIARY LINE AND MALAR STRIPE CREAM-WHITE. THE BREAST, FLANKS AND BELLY WERE COVERED WITH RATHER COARSE BROWN STREAKS; THE STREAKS ENDED ABRUPTLY AT THE POSTERIOR MARGIN OF THE BELLY. UNDERTAIL COVERTS CREAM-WHITE, WITHOUT STREAKS. EYE DARK; BILL SHORT, CONICAL, GRAYISH W/YELLOWISH NEAR BASE, CULMEN CURVED.

KEY FIELD MARKS: DARK CHEEK, STRONGLY OUTLINED BY WHITISH LINES ABOVE AND BELOW IT; CURVED CULMEN; UNSTREAKED UNDERTAIL COVERTS; SIZE BETWEEN HOUSE AND CASSIN'S FINCHES. THE BIRD'S SINGLE MOST OUTSTANDING FEATURE WAS CONTRAST, BOTH IN THE HEAD PATTERN AND IN THE UNDERSIDE STREAKING. IT APPEARED AS A BROWN AND WHITE BIRD, RATHER THAN A SUBTLY SHADED ONE.

Describe the bird's song or call, if heard, including method of delivery, i.e., from perch, in flight, etc: NOT HEARD

Describe the habitat in which you observed this bird:

PLAINS SHELTERBELT, WITH ARTIFICIALLY PLANTED ROWS OF RUSSIAN OLIVES AND PINES ON THE OUTSIDE. THE BIRD SEEMED TO PREFER THE OLIVES TO THE PINES. NOT SEEN ON THE GROUND.

How were similarly appearing species eliminated?

HOUSE FINCH: HEAD MOSTLY DARK (BROWNISH) WITHOUT OBVIOUS SUPERCILIARY CONTRAST. STREAKINGS ON UNDERPARTS BLURRY, BASE COLOR PALE BROWNISH, WITH AN OVERALL LOW-CONTRAST.

CASSIN'S FINCH: UNDERPARTS MORE FINELY STREAKED, UNDERTAIL COVERTS STREAKED, SIZE LARGER, CULMEN STRAIGHT, HEAD PATTERN LESS DISTINCT.

FOX SPARROW: TAIL QUITE LONG, RUSTY, BREAST STREAKINGS CONCENTRATED INTO A LARGE SPOT (USUALLY), CHEEK RUSTY, BACK GRAYISH WITH RUSTY STREAKS. TAIL NOT STRONGLY NOTCHED.

SONG SPARROW: BREAST SPOT; LONG, ROUNDED TAIL, CHEEK PALER WITH DARK OUTLINE, MUCH GRAYER OVERALL COLORATION (USUALLY). HABITAT DIFFERENT.

IN POINT OF RANGE, HOUSE FINCHES ARE NEVER COMMON AT BONNY, AND I DON'T KNOW THAT CASSIN'S HAS EVER BEEN RECORDED THERE. THE FOX AND SONG SPARROWS HAVE BOTH BEEN SEEN THERE, BUT BOTH PREFER WETTER HABITATS. MEANWHILE, THE HABITAT SEEMS SUITABLE FOR THE PURPLE FINCH, WHICH DOES NOT ~~USUALLY~~ OCCUR VERY FAR FROM BONNY IN ITS HOME RANGE.

Prior experience with this and similarly appearing species:

HOUSE FINCH AND CASSIN'S FINCH ARE BOTH FAMILIAR FROM BIRDING IN THE FRONT RANGE. THE UBIQUITOUS SONG SPARROW IS QUITE FAMILIAR AS I HAVE SEEN ITS MANY COLOR FORMS THROUGHOUT THE STATE. I HAVE OBSERVED THE WESTERN FOX SPARROW IN MIDDLE PARK ON ONE OCCASION (2 INDIVIDUALS) AND THE EASTERN FOX SPARROW ON 2 OCCASIONS (ONE INDIVIDUAL EACH TIME), ONCE AT BONNY 11/16 AND ONCE AT WATERTON 1/25. I HAVE OBSERVED ONE OTHER ♀ PURPLE FINCH AT BOULDER 11/75 (IT WAS SEEN TWICE IN A WEEK).

Books, illustrations and advice consulted and how did these influence this documentation?

THE STANDARD FIELD GUIDES PROVIDED CONFIRMATION, THOUGH THE AMOUNT OF UNDERTAIL COVERT STREAKING IS NOT CONSIDERED IN THEM. THE BIRDS OF COLORADO DOES INCLUDE A DISCUSSION OF THIS MARK.

This report was written from notes made during x after observation; from memory .

PRINT NAME: PETER MOULTON SIGNATURE: Peter Moulton DATE: 2/12/77
Street Address: 1328 So. COFFMAN ST. #3 Town and State: LONGMONT, COLO. ZIP: 80501

Return to: JACK REDDALL - 4450 South Alton Street, Englewood, Colorado 80110